



STATUS REPORT

Zimbabwe: status report

Edition of 2026-08-13 · 144 systems and instruments tracked, 9 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-11 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/ZWE/ledger.csv](#) (144 systems and instruments, 9 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Zimbabwe has a data protection statute in force and no administrative sanctions under it. The Cyber and Data Protection Act has applied since 2022, with the communications regulator designated as data protection authority ([the Act](#)); the regulator stated in May 2026 that administrative sanctions are not yet in place, leaving criminal penalties of up to seven years' imprisonment for the accountable chief executive as the only enforcement route ([regulator account](#)). Mandatory compliance inspections begin on 1 September 2026 ([notice account](#)).

The National AI Strategy 2026-2030, launched on 13 March 2026, provides for an implementation office, a regulatory committee, a data platform, a fusion centre and a sovereign national cloud ([launch account](#)). All five remain proposals, and a media rights organisation records that the strategy has no legal force ([organisation analysis](#)).

The identity system that would underpin any of it has not started. A national digital identity was announced in May 2025 for a July 2025 start and no launch, enrolment or coverage figure is on record ([ministerial account](#)).

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Broadband mapping programme	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	The minister told the National Assembly government is working with operators to identify poor-coverage areas
Cross-border fibre corridor to Zambia	IMPLEMENTED, PHASE 1 ONLY ↗	Plumtree to Bulawayo carrying traffic

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Econet InfraCo	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Listed by introduction on the foreign-currency exchange 2026-03-31
Government satellite kit donation programme	IMPLEMENTED, ACTIVATION UNFUNDED ↗	The health minister told the National Assembly the kits are not activated
Parent company's stock exchange listing	DISCONTINUED, VOLUNTARY DELISTING ↗	Board resolved voluntary delisting 2025-12-15
Satellite operator's licence terms and fee	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Two licences issued 2024-09-06
Starlink satellite service	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Service launched September 2024, after the 2024 cut-off order
State mobile operator turnaround plan	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	A US\$1bn-by-2029 target restated at the annual general meeting
Tower relocation programme	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Described to the National Assembly 2026-05-16
Uncapped fibre package at US\$99	IMPLEMENTED ↗	500 Mbps uncapped at US\$99
Regulator's Q1 2026 sector performance report	NOT HELD	—

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National data centre ecosystem	PLANNED ↗	Committed in the ICT minister's five-point policy compass
National high-performance computing centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Phase 2 grant of CNY 100,000,000 signed 2017-12-06, implementation from 2018
Operator artificial-intelligence service	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-04-15; the operator states the compute is hosted in South Africa
Sovereign national cloud	PLANNED ↗	Provided for in the National AI Strategy 2026-2030, launched 2026-03-13
State or government data centre inventory	IMPLEMENTED ↗	TelOne's own product page states its facility is a Tier 3 Data Centre Environment, the operator's own undated claim, not certified or dated
Technology park and data centre, Harare	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Groundbreaking expected in the fourth quarter of the financial year

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
100 MW solar farm for the technology park	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Phase 1 construction commenced in the quarter to May 2026
Artificial-intelligence fuel management on tower sites	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Phased rollout reported for the quarter to May 2026
Base-station solar programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Solar systems deployed across new and existing sites in the quarter to May 2026
Power company generation licence and installed capacity	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Generation Licence GC0066/2018 issued 2018-03-27
Solar for Health programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	1,044 health facilities solarised across all ten provinces (2025-08)

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National internet exchange point	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reported to the ITU Regional Development Forum for Africa 2020-10-06
Regulator's international bandwidth measurement framework	IMPLEMENTED, SATELLITE OPERATOR EXCLUDED ↗	The satellite operator excluded and the baseline restated from Q2 2025

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity fusion centre	PLANNED ↗	Proposed in the National AI Strategy 2026-2030
Cyber security and monitoring of interception of communications centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Established as a unit in the Office of the President by the Cyber and Data Protection Act
National Child Online Protection Policy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reported as established alongside the National Cybersecurity Strategy
National computer incident response team	IN DEVELOPMENT, NO COMPLETION RECORDED ↗	ITU project 9ZIM17008 ran 2017-07-01 to 2021-02-28 with no completion recorded
National Cybersecurity Strategy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched in Harare 2025-10-15
National Cybersecurity Strategy document	NOT HELD	—

Satellite terminal subscriptions reached 67,057 by the fourth quarter of 2025, up 31.62% on the quarter ([regulator report](#)). Two licences were issued to the operator on 6 September 2024, conditional on the regulator clearing every agent and dealer distributing terminals; the widely cited US\$575,000 is the trade press's arithmetic on the 2021 fee schedule, not a regulator figure ([regulator statement](#)).

The satellite operator was excluded from the regulator's equipped international bandwidth table from the second quarter of 2025 and remained excluded at the fourth, while carrying 35.05% of fixed internet and data traffic ([analysis](#)).

Fifth-generation service reaches 18.9% of the population and 0.0% of the rural population ([regulator report](#)). The Harare Internet Exchange Point was built on a US\$200,000 African Union Commission grant and housed in the state fixed operator's exchange building; when the regulator reported it to the ITU in October 2020 every Zimbabwean access provider was connected and it had two international peers ([regulator contribution](#)). The ITU's record of the project to establish a national incident response team, which ran to 28 February 2021, still states that its achievements will be updated on completion ([project record](#)). The ICT ministry's own 2025 list of priority projects separately names establishment of a national computer incident response team (ZW-CIRT), for monitoring, detecting and responding to cyber threats, alongside a National Data Centre project; neither carries a completion date or operating status ([priority projects](#)).

None of the commercial storage estate is carrier-neutral: an analyst brief for a European Union facility put about six live facilities at roughly 2 MW of live load, on 2024 estimates ([market brief](#)). The state fixed operator's own product page states its data centre environment is Tier 3 standard, an undated and uncertified operator claim, vendor- and ICT-provider-neutral, running Microsoft HyperV, VMware, OpenStack and Huawei FusionSphere virtual-machine platforms with active-active redundancy across multiple data centres nationally ([TelOne product page](#)). A health financing partner reports 1,044 health facilities solarised across all ten provinces, more than 60% of the total, on 11 megawatts of capacity ([case study](#)).

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Health information exchange	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Ministry of Health and Child Care's Zimbabwe Core FHIR Implementation Guide (ZWCore) held as a continuous-build draft, version 0.1.0
Mandated open interface standards for public-sector platforms	PLANNED ↗	Committed in the ICT minister's five-point policy compass
Online border management system	IMPLEMENTED, PHASED ↗	Phased rollout from January 2025 after 2024 pilots
Whole-of-government enterprise resource planning system	IMPLEMENTED, DEPLOYMENT COVERAGE NOT STATED ↗	Launched at a technology institute 2026-07-29
Government interoperability framework	NOT HELD	—

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cotton farmer biometric registry	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	The marketing authority cleared to proceed; field teams stated for 2025-10-15
Electronic passport	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Enrolment centres in ten districts, eight provincial centres and one abroad
Mobile civil registration exercise 2022	IMPLEMENTED, COMPLETED ↗	Ran 2022-02-01 to 2022-09-30; 3,203,389 documents issued
Mobile registration drive in Binga	IMPLEMENTED, COMPLETED ↗	Ran 7-11 July 2025 with two donor partners
National digital identity	PLANNED ↗	Announced May 2025 for a July 2025 start; no start recorded
Population registry system modernisation	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Modernisation begun around 2023
Tobacco farmer identity registry	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Cited as the model the cotton registry emulates
National digital identity enrolment statistics	NOT HELD	—

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Bank charge caps	IMPLEMENTED, ENFORCEMENT CAPACITY QUESTIONED ↗	Compliance directed by 2026-03-31
Cash-recycler machines at retail outlets	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Ten installed, 78 stated in the pipeline
Central bank digital transformation and financial technology department	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Established with a regulatory sandbox and an innovation hub
Central bank national payment systems report	IMPLEMENTED ↗	The report for the fourth quarter ending 31 December 2025, issued January 2026
Interoperable quick-response payments	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	The switch operator reports rollout under way
Mobile money and interbank transfer limits	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Raised in the 2026 Monetary Policy Statement
Mobile wallet cash-out at bank machines	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Interbank settlement onto two bank machine estates
Pan-African payment and settlement system participation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reported by the switch operator to a payments conference

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Radio-frequency toll tag express lanes	IMPLEMENTED, TWO PLAZAS OF 29 ↗	The first plaza handed over 2026-07-29
Regional real-time gross settlement onboarding	PLANNED ↗	The system operator cites potential onboarding by end-2027
Zimbabwe Entrepreneurship Exchange (ZEEX)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Described as a newly approved digital capital-market venue at the signing of a growth-capital memorandum of understanding

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digital land administration platform	PILOTING ↗	Sixteen law firms selected for a two-week validation pilot
Statutory Instrument 76 of 2025 on securitised deeds	IMPLEMENTED, COMMENCEMENT TRIGGER STATED TWO WAYS ↗	Gazetted 2025-07-18
Taxpayer registration self-service portal	IMPLEMENTED, PHASE 2 PENDING ↗	ZIMRA reports readying a second phase of the wider Tax and Revenue Management System (TaRMS), integrating third-party stakeholders
Transfer of the voters' roll to the registrar-general	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	The justice minister told the Senate implementation has begun

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
E-Health Strategy 2012-2017	DISCONTINUED, NO SUCCESSOR HELD ↗	Term ended 2017 with no successor strategy held
National health management information system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	1,254 of a planned 1,900 facilities implementing the national electronic medical record (2025-08)
Operator telehealth programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A virtual telemedicine hospital opened in Matabeleland South

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Government information technology specification standards	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Version 2.0 issued May 2025 by the E-Government Technology Unit
Parliamentary artificial-intelligence competency programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	The implementing partner reports work with research, committee and budget-office staff
Smart Zimbabwe 2030 master plan	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Issued by the ICT ministry, undated; builds on the Zimbabwe National Policy on ICTs 2016-2020 and the SMART Africa Manifesto
National electronic services portal	NOT HELD	—

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Universal services fund subscription support	IMPLEMENTED, SCOPE LIMITED ↗	The ICT minister told the National Assembly the scope covers digital centres and schools

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Local authority electronic services and revenue systems	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Kwekwe City Council's own page states billing runs on the Promun (ERP) package
Satellite kits for local authorities	IMPLEMENTED, HANDOVER ONLY ↗	250 kits handed to the local government ministry

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
ICT access by households and use by individuals survey	IMPLEMENTED ↗	The 2025 round released 2026-07-20; 9,245 households, 91.3% response
Regulator's abridged sector performance report	IMPLEMENTED ↗	The Q4 2025 edition, reporting period October to December 2025
The 2025 household survey report	NOT HELD	—

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National geospatial and earth-observation data programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Agency established by General Notice 483 of 2019

The central bank reported 511.1 million electronic transactions worth ZiG1.37 trillion in the six months to 30 June 2026, and the same conference heard that of hundreds of thousands of cards in the market only about 20,000 are in use ([conference account](#)). The central bank's own fourth-quarter payment systems report, held for the first time, puts electronic transactions at ZiG736.03bn in the quarter to 31 December 2025, up 7.78% on the third quarter, with mobile money carrying 86.70% of volume but only 10.51% of value against RTGS's 58.29% of value on 1.20% of volume ([RBZ report](#)). The stock exchange and a corporate-capital firm signed a memorandum of understanding in July 2026 to channel growth capital into SMEs through the Zimbabwe Entrepreneurship Exchange (ZEEX), a newly approved venue combining primary-market fundraising, asset tokenisation and secondary-market trading; no capital commitment or listing timetable is stated ([MOU account](#)).

The Smart Zimbabwe 2030 master plan, previously known to the base only at second hand, is now held in full: it sets a National Data Centre as a Smart Government outcome and records, as at December 2018, no interoperability between data centres, systems and databases across ministries ([master plan](#)). The Office of the President and Cabinet's E-Government Technology Unit issued Version 2.0 of the government-wide ICT specification standards in May 2025, revising the May 2023 original as the reference standard for all public-sector ICT procurement ([standards](#)). ZIMRA is readying a second phase of its Tax and Revenue Management System (TaRMS), integrating third-party stakeholders after a first phase said to have improved data integrity, payment accuracy and taxpayer compliance ([TaRMS account](#)). Kwekwe City Council's own account of its finance department states billing runs on the Promun (ERP) package across rates, refuse, sewerage and water charges, with an explicit information-technology and e-governance function ([council page](#)).

The 2026 monetary policy statement capped cash withdrawal charges at 2% and card terminal charges at 1.5% to a maximum of US\$20, and raised transfer limits to ZiG13,000 per transaction with a ZiG50,000 monthly cap ([policy account](#)). A named analyst records the governor conceding limited capacity to enforce them ([analysis](#)).

Against about 1.5 million undocumented children and passport backlogs recorded at more than 300,000 in 2022, the home affairs minister told the Senate in May 2026 that he was not aware of any backlog ([Senate account](#)). Civil registration is computerised in all ten provinces and 63 districts but in more than 20 of 209 sub-offices ([registrars' meeting](#)). A mobile exercise issued 3,203,389 registration documents free between February and September 2022 against a target of 2 million ([ministerial statement](#)).

The national electronic medical record, Impilo, is implemented at 1,254 of a planned 1,900 health facilities, and a health information exchange to connect laboratory systems, logistics management and DHIS2 to it is under development; both are reported by a health financing partner, not the ministry ([case study](#)). The health ministry's own platform now describes Impilo as a national health operating system spanning care-finding, provider verification, medicines and diagnostics directories and virtual care, most of it usable without a citizen account ([platform](#)), and its continuous-build Core FHIR Implementation Guide (ZWCORE), marked for demonstration purposes only, defines national profiles for patient, encounter and facility resources ([FHIR guide](#)). The e-health strategy that named interoperability and patient privacy as preconditions ran to 2017, and no successor is held.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cyber and Data Protection Act	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Consolidation gazetted 2022-03-11
Local-ownership rule for telecommunications operators and its repeal	DISCONTINUED, REPEAL REPORTED AND UNVERIFIED ↗	Gazetted 2026-06-12; reported repealed by Statutory Instrument 111 of 2026
Postal and Telecommunications (Amendment) Bill, 2025	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Gazetted 2025-10-10; before the Parliamentary Legal Committee 2026-08-02
Regulatory Notice 1 of 2026	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reported 2026-03-27; text not held
Regulatory Notice 2 of 2026	IMPLEMENTED, INSPECTIONS BEGIN 2026-09-01 ↗	Run in the press 2026-07-26
Statutory Instrument 155 of 2024 on data-controller licensing	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Gazetted 2024-09-13; licence applications due six months on
Third constitutional amendment on the voters' roll	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	The justice minister told the Senate implementation had begun

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Artificial-intelligence ethics framework	PLANNED ↗	The ministry committed to tabling by the end of the first quarter of 2027
Artificial-intelligence strategy implementation office	PLANNED ↗	Provided for in the strategy, to sit in the ICT ministry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Central bank department for digital transformation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Announced established at a technology convergence forum
National AI Council	PLANNED ↗	Named in the National AI Strategy as the critical first step
National AI Strategy 2026-2030	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Approved by Cabinet 2025-10-14; launched by the President 2026-03-13
National artificial-intelligence act	PLANNED ↗	Proposed by the National AI Strategy; no draft on record
National artificial-intelligence regulatory sandbox	PLANNED ↗	Named in the strategy as the "Innovation Crucible"; a supervising council announced 2026-08-04
National digital regulatory committee	PLANNED ↗	Provided for in the strategy, reporting to the regulator
National ICT Policy 2022-2027	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed by President Mnangagwa; the document states no adoption or publication date
ICT Policy 2026-2030	NOT HELD	—

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Zimbabwe-European Union digital or artificial-intelligence cooperation instrument	IMPLEMENTED, NO DIGITAL PRIORITY AREA ↗	Multiannual Indicative Programme 2021-2027 adopted under Commission Implementing Decision C(2021)9056
Zimbabwe-Rwanda memorandum on immigration cooperation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed 2024; a benchmarking visit 2026-07-29

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National artificial-intelligence technical standards	PLANNED ↗	Proposed by the National AI Strategy

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Administrative sanctions under the data protection act	PLANNED ↗	The regulator stated they are not yet in place
Data protection officer certification	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Certification required of every officer, at US\$1,250 plus a US\$30 application fee
National Data Agency	PLANNED ↗	Provided for in the National AI Strategy, approved by Cabinet 2025-10-14
Privacy responsibility challenge	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched by the regulator, reported for the January-February 2026 round

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Public consultation record for the National AI Strategy	IMPLEMENTED, THE STRATEGY'S OWN RECORD ONLY ↗	Consultations recorded in the strategy, closing at Masvingo 2025-09-11

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National artificial-intelligence and data platform	PLANNED ↗	Provided for in the strategy, to be introduced gradually
Open government data initiative under the strategy	PLANNED ↗	A National Data Commons announced at the AI for Impact launch 2026-08-04

Licences under the 2024 regulations ran from 570 institutions in June 2025 to 721 by October 2025, and trained data protection officers from more than 500 to about 1,200 ([regulator account](#)). A notice run in the press on 26 July 2026 sets mandatory risk-based inspections from 1 September, with certification of every officer at US\$1,250 plus a US\$30 application fee ([notice account](#)). Licence fees under the same regulations are tiered by data-subject count – US\$50 a year for 50-1,000 subjects, US\$300 plus a US\$30 application fee for 1,001-100,000, and US\$500-2,500 above that – so an organisation in the lowest band faces over US\$1,300 of first-year compliance cost; a legal expert calls the registration-and-fee model itself, rather than the underlying data protection, "new and strange" ([fee account](#)). Neither notice has been published by the regulator itself.

The operative National ICT Policy 2022-2027, signed by President Mnangagwa and previously known to the base only through later documents that cite it, is now held in full: its legislative programme commits to enacting frameworks for a National Data Centre, cloud computing and big data, and digital financial services, and to legislating autonomous regulatory bodies; the document itself states no adoption or publication date ([the policy](#)).

The National AI Strategy 2026-2030 is now held in full. Cabinet approved it on 14 October 2025 ([post-Cabinet briefing](#)); it sets out four strategic pillars, five flagship initiatives and three phases to 2030, and carries no publication date, no financing envelope and no costed action plan ([strategy](#)). Its proposed act, implementation office, national council, data agency, regulatory committee and sandbox are all still proposals. A media rights organisation reports that the strategy has no legal force, and that the monitoring centre established by the 2021 Act operates under the Office of the President with no judicial oversight ([organisation analysis](#)).

An amendment bill to the statute that constitutes the regulator was gazetted on 10 October 2025, is not in force, and sat with the Parliamentary Legal Committee on 2 August 2026; its replacement section 25 requires ministerial directions to the regulator to be prospective and of general application ([Bill](#)). A statutory instrument gazetted on 12 June 2026 barred the regulator from licensing any applicant less than 75% owned by Zimbabwean citizens; it is reported repealed in full by an instrument the base does not hold ([the instrument](#)).

The justice minister told the Senate on 23 July 2026 that transfer of the voters' roll to the registrar-general has begun, stating no date, transition plan or safeguard ([Senate account](#)).

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Artificial-intelligence literacy campaign	PLANNED ↗	Introduced in the National AI Strategy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Artificial-intelligence remote monitoring and digital twin	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Described as advancing in the trading update for the quarter ended May 2026
Harare traffic management system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reported in operation and described as developed by the state operator
Indigenous-language corpora programme	PLANNED ↗	Committed, universities to lead, part-financed from the universal services fund
National artificial-intelligence compute siting	IMPLEMENTED, SITED OUTSIDE ZIMBABWE ↗	Stated in the operator's own launch announcement 2026-04-15
National artificial-intelligence innovation fund	PLANNED ↗	Named in the strategy as the "Mugove/Isabelo" fund; a Zimbabwe Innovation Catalyst Fund announced 2026-08-04
National truth-verification platform	PLANNED ↗	Proposed in the National AI Strategy
University high-performance computer	IMPLEMENTED, ACCESS CONSTRAINED ↗	Operating, with access quoted in large blocks rather than pay-as-you-go

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Scheme of reconstruction transferring passive infrastructure	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Completion notified to stakeholders and landlords 2025-12-24

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Central bank innovation hub	PLANNED ↗	Announced as to be created under the new department
Central bank regulatory sandbox	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Cited by the central bank as operating

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Bilateral health cooperation memorandum	DISCONTINUED, ZIMBABWE WITHDREW ↗	Harare withdrew from talks after a presidential memo of 2025-12-23
Cloud partner experience centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Opened at an inaugural cloud summit in Johannesburg
Satellite operator's licence award date and terms	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Two licences issued 2024-09-06, announced four days later
Terrestrial segment of a trans-continental cable	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Ready for service stated as 2027

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Chinese-supplied city surveillance systems	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Mapped across eleven countries including Zimbabwe
National data centre, Harare	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched February 2021 under a US\$98m national broadband initiative

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Coding programme delivered with the United Arab Emirates	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Described as a flagship programme delivered with the United Arab Emirates
Digital skills partnership agreement with the United Arab Emirates	NOT HELD	—

The compute behind the operator artificial-intelligence service launched in April 2026 is hosted at an affiliated group's facility in South Africa, stated in the operator's own launch announcement ([announcement](#)). A trade account reports the university high-performance computer quoted to local developers at tens of thousands of United States dollars for limited access in large blocks ([account](#)).

A media rights organisation reports that the proposed truth-verification platform names no supervising institution, criteria or safeguards, and that the fusion centre carries no governance structure, no limit on data collection, retention or use, and no route to challenge a threat assessment ([organisation analysis](#)).

Harare ended talks on a bilateral health cooperation memorandum in February 2026 over long-term United States access to national health data. The United States embassy stated in August 2026 that the memorandum's conditions were co-investment, financial accountability and the sharing of disease specimens during outbreaks, and that assertions it sought Zimbabweans' personal data are categorically false ([embassy statement](#)). Both accounts are supportable on the strategy's own model texts, acquired in August 2026: the [model data sharing agreement](#) gives the United States secure, uninterrupted access, expressly including login credentials, to seven national health systems including electronic medical records, for twenty-five years continuing ten years past termination — and in the same clause tells the partner government that to the maximum extent practical it should not provide individual level data or personally identifiable information unless there is no other way, the model access role being a viewer role without access to such information. The [template memorandum](#) requires physical specimens and related data, including genetic sequence data, of detected pathogens with epidemic potential to be provided within five days of detection, for twenty-five years. Neither text is the Zimbabwe draft, which was never signed and has not been published (2026-08-09).

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Satellite retail service affordability	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Subscriptions at 67,057 at Q4 2025

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digital centres programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Described as established nationwide, offering free internet, equipment and literacy training
Free public Wi-Fi hotspot programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	409 hotspots deploying, stated at an annual telecommunications conference

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National financial inclusion strategy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reserve Bank of Zimbabwe's NFIS II, foreword by Governor J.P. Mangudya, period 2022-2026
Presidential internet scheme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Cited in a post-Cabinet briefing as the channel for satellite access
Satellite connectivity at rural health facilities	IN DEVELOPMENT, KITS NOT ACTIVATED ↗	The health minister told the National Assembly subscriptions are unpaid

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National digital literacy programme or measured literacy rate	NOT HELD	—

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Artificial-intelligence grand challenge	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched as the AI for Impact (AI4I) Grand Challenge 2026-08-04
Coding in the secondary curriculum	PLANNED ↗	Directed at a national seminar on digital sovereignty
Digital skills ambassadors programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Named at the National AI Strategy launch
Digital skills programme targeting 1.5 million people	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Described as delivered in partnership with a Gulf state
Government cybersecurity youth training programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	More than 3,000 youths trained
Youth digital skills programme (donor-funded)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A SEK 36,000,000 commitment, 2023

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National research programme or research and development expenditure figure	IMPLEMENTED, NO R&D EXPENDITURE FIGURE PUBLISHED ↗	RCZ's 2023 and 2024 annual reports both confirm no gross R&D expenditure or R&D-as-share-of-GDP figure is published

Household internet access reached 75.5% in the 2025 survey against 50.1% in 2020, while household computer ownership fell to 11.2% from 14.2%, at 21.2% urban against 4.7% rural ([survey account](#)).

The national financial inclusion strategy is now held in full: the Reserve Bank's second-phase strategy (2022-2026) targets a rise in overall usage of formal financial services from 70% to 90%, with a digital financial services target of 77% to 90% on transactional accounts, and carries no costed action plan or funding envelope ([strategy](#)). The Research Council of Zimbabwe's 2023 and 2024 annual reports both confirm no gross domestic expenditure on research and development, or R&D-as-share-of-GDP figure, has been published for Zimbabwe ([2023 report](#)).

More than 400 health facilities hold satellite kits, none activated because the health ministry states the subscription fees are too high, and the universal services fund covers subscriptions only for digital centres and schools, for one year ([National Assembly account](#)).

The grand challenge provided for in the strategy was launched on 4 August 2026 across agriculture, health, education, financial services, mining and public administration ([launch account](#)); the regulator reported 738 applications and 68 projects selected for an August boot camp in Nyanga, narrowed to 18 candidates for the next stage, with no award or budget published ([Nyanga account](#)).

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Export credit facility for mobile network expansion	IMPLEMENTED ↗	CNY 485,000,000 committed 2019, start year 2021
Grant for the high-performance computing centre, phase 2	IMPLEMENTED ↗	CNY 100,000,000 grant committed 2017, start year 2018
Interest-free loan for the high-performance computing centre, phase 1	DISCONTINUED ↗	Facility end year 2015
Preferential buyer's credit for fixed broadband expansion	DISCONTINUED ↗	Facility end year 2019
Ring-fenced fund share for public-good artificial intelligence	PLANNED ↗	Committed in the ministry's five-point policy compass; no amount stated
Syndicated vendor loan to the private mobile operator	IMPLEMENTED ↗	US\$300m of a US\$500m group facility channelled to the Zimbabwe operator
Universal services fund	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Scope stated in the National Assembly
Universal services fund levy rate, balance and annual disbursement	IMPLEMENTED, BALANCE AND DISBURSEMENT NOT PUBLISHED ↗	Contribution rates set by statutory instrument; the Auditor-General's 2024 report publishes no balance

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cross-border fibre public-private partnership	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Phase 1 switched on

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Citizens budget	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Published for the 2025 financial year
Digital and information technology appropriation in the 2026 national budget	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Appropriated in the Appropriation Act 2026 (Act No. 6 of 2025)
Parliamentary budget office	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Assessed in the 2025 open budget survey round, cut-off 2024-12-31

External financing on record is old and largely Chinese: two export-credit facilities and two grants for a computing centre, the newest committed in 2019. The one recent commitment, a SEK 36,000,000 youth digital skills grant of 2023, still shows nothing disbursed ([grant record](#)).

The 2026 Appropriation Act votes ZiG258,292,000 to ICT ministry policy and administration, ZiG505,225,000 to ICT development and promotion, ZiG1,470,460,000 to civil registration and ZiG994,652,000 to migration management ([the Act](#)). Telecommunications licensees pay 1.5% of monthly gross turnover into the universal services fund ([2021 regulations](#)), and the Auditor-General audited that fund for 2023 and 2024 and published no balance, contribution total or disbursement figure ([audit report](#)).

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Digital skills partnership agreement with the United Arab Emirates	The signed memorandum or programme document behind the 1.5 million coding programme; the base carries one excerpt source naming the partner and one later restatement of the target that does not, with no signing date, value, delivery partner or enrolment figure	2026-08-06
The 2025 household survey report	The statistics agency and regulator publication itself; the base holds only one outlet's account, so the sample design, provincial breakdowns and the rural and urban series behind the headline figures are that outlet's selection	2026-08-06
Government interoperability framework	A published interoperability framework or data-exchange specification; the base holds the technology unit naming connectivity across ministries as the hurdle and a ministerial commitment to open interface standards, and no framework document	2026-08-06
National electronic services portal	The address and service inventory of a citizen-facing government services portal; the base holds two sector portals and nothing that aggregates services	2026-08-06
National digital identity enrolment statistics	Any registrar-general or home affairs figure for cards issued or persons enrolled; the base establishes the announcement and the non-start, and holds no enrolment number at any date	2026-08-06
ICT Policy 2026-2030	The policy document, or a gazette notice or ministry release announcing it; the base carries only the statistics agency's director-general naming it on 2026-07-20 as a framework the household survey will inform	2026-08-06
National digital literacy programme or measured literacy rate	A statistics agency or regulator digital-skills module, or a named national literacy programme document; the base carries one source on this subject, a continental review, and literacy appears only as a barrier named by the central bank and as a service offered at digital centres	2026-08-06
Regulator's Q1 2026 sector performance report	The regulator's own quarterly report; the base holds the Q4 2025 report in full but carries Q1 2026 only through a news account of a post-Cabinet briefing, so the 379 base stations, the 19,000 km backbone and the 57.28% traffic rise are all secondary and no per-operator table exists to check them against	2026-08-06
National Cybersecurity Strategy document	The strategy itself; the base holds a one-minute report of the October 2025 launch and nothing else — no objectives, institutional arrangements, timetable or budget, and no subsequent milestone	2026-08-06

The largest remaining absence is the documents that govern the sector. The National Cybersecurity Strategy launched in October 2025 exists in the base as a one-minute news report, and the probe of 6 August found it deliberately unpublished, its details recorded as confidential at the time of the launch.

The second is the regulator's own statistics: the Q1 2026 sector performance report is carried only through a news account of a post-Cabinet briefing, so the 379 base stations, the 19,000 km backbone and the 57.28% traffic rise have no per-operator table behind them. The third is delivery under the identity programme, where no figure for cards issued or persons enrolled is held at any date.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-13
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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.